StoryCast

Project documentation. Ishimwe Sam Nelson, African Leadership University. October 2026.

1. Overview

StoryCast is a three-page accessible microsite built without frameworks: semantic HTML5, Sass compiled to CSS, and a small amount of vanilla JavaScript for progressive enhancement. The repository is at `github.com/nezyman/storycast`.

2. Structure

Path	Contents
`index.html`, `about.html`	Home page and About / Access page
`story/`	Three story detail pages: one video, two audio
`sass/`	`main.scss`, token partials `_colors`, `_typography`, `_spacing`, and base, layout and component partials
`css/main.css`	Compiled stylesheet
`js/storycast.js`	Transcript sync and single-player behaviour
`assets/`	Audio, video, WebVTT captions, text transcripts, images
`docs/`	Research and documentation PDFs

3. Sass architecture

Design tokens live in three partials and are consumed with `@use`, so each partial states exactly what it depends on. Components have one partial each.

Partial	Role
`_colors.scss`	Ink, paper, surface, primary, accent, muted and border colours
`_typography.scss`	Font stacks, size scale, weights, line measure
`_spacing.scss`	Spacing scale, radii, minimum target size
`_base.scss`	Box sizing, body defaults, link style, focus ring, skip link
`_layout.scss`	Headings, header, footer, hero, section, story grid, buttons
`_media-card.scss`	Story card and its container queries
`_story.scss`	Breadcrumb, two-column story layout, media figure, sidebar panels

`_transcript.scss`	Transcript list, timestamp buttons, active line
`_about.scss`	Feature list and keyboard guide table

4. Responsive techniques

CSS Grid

The story grid uses `repeat(auto-fit, minmax(min(100%, 22rem), 1fr))`. The story page becomes two columns from 60rem. Transcript rows use a fixed timestamp column and a flexible text column.

Flexbox

Header, navigation, footer, button rows and metadata tags wrap naturally at any width.

Container query

Each card is wrapped in an element with `container-type: inline-size`. At a container width of 34rem or more the card changes to an image-left layout. Under 20rem the metadata tags stack vertically.

5. Accessibility implementation

Area	Implementation
Structure	Landmarks, one `h1` per page, ordered headings, labelled navs
Media	`video` with `track kind="captions"`, `audio` with transcript, `figcaption` description linked with `aria-describedby`
Keyboard	Skip link first, visible focus ring, timestamps are `button` elements
Contrast	Body 15.7:1, links 7.29:1, muted 7.96:1, hero eyebrow 5.32:1, borders above 3:1
Not colour alone	Current nav item and active transcript line use weight, underline or a bar as well as colour
ARIA	Only where HTML falls short: labelled landmarks, `aria-current`, described media, timestamp button labels
No sound clash	Starting a player pauses any other

6. How the JavaScript works

The script reads each transcript list tied to a player through `data-player`. It turns each timestamp into a button that sets the player's `currentTime`, and on `timeupdate` it marks the line being spoken. A document-level `play` listener pauses any other media. Without JavaScript the transcript is still a readable ordered list and the media keeps its native controls.

7. Run locally

Step	Command
Install	`npm install`
Compile Sass once	`npm run build`
Compile on every save	`npm run watch`
Serve	VS Code Live Server on `index.html`, or `npx serve`

8. Testing

- Keyboard only: Tab through every page, check the skip link, focus ring and timestamp buttons.
- Captions: play the video story and confirm captions show by default and can be turned off.
- Contrast: ratios computed from the colour tokens against WCAG 2.1 AA thresholds.
- Responsive: checked at phone, tablet and desktop widths, and with browser zoom at 200 percent.

9. Known limitations

- No separate audio-described soundtrack for the video.
- Captions are in English only.
- Narration is a synthetic demo voice and the stories are fictional.